

Aesthetic - Aesthetic is the inclusion of references to artistic elements or expressions within a textual work.

Aestheticism - It is an art movement supporting the emphasis of aesthetic values more than other themes for literature, fine art, music and other arts.

Allegory - Allegory is a story, play, picture etc. in which each character or event is a symbol representing an idea or a quality, such as truth, evil, death etc. It is used to teach some kind of moral lesson.

Aside - An aside is a literary term referencing a remark or passage in a play that is intended to be heard by the audience but not by any other characters.

Antagonist - Antagonist is the major character in opposition to the hero or protagonist of a narrative or drama.

Antithesis - Antithesis is a rhetorical device in which two opposite ideas are put together in a sentence to achieve a contrasting effect.

Archetype - An archetype is a literary device in which a character is created based on a set of qualities or traits that are specific and identifiable for readers.

Avant-garde - Avant-garde is a work that is experimental, radical or unorthodox with respect to art, culture or society.

Anachronism - Anachronism is a literary device that places someone or something associated with a particular time in history in the wrong time period.

Anticlimax - Anticlimax is a rhetorical device in which an ending or conclusion is unsatisfying to the audience.

Aphorism - Aphorism is a statement of truth or opinion expressed in a concise and witty manner.

Archaism - Archaism is the use of writing that is today considered outdated or old fashioned.

Bathos - Bathos is a sudden change of tone in a work of writing, usually from the sublime to the ridiculous. The term was coined by Alexander Pope in 1727.

Blank Verse - Blank verse refers to poetry written in unrhymed but metered lines, almost always iambic pentameter.

Bombast - Bombast is a particular style of speech or writing that is pretentious, hyperbolic and full of extravagant language.

Burlesque - It is the comic imitation of a serious literary or artistic form that relies on an extravagant incongruity between a subject and its treatment.

Caesura - A caesura is a pause that occurs within a line of poetry, usually marked by some form of punctuation such as a period, comma, ellipsis or dash.

Canto - A canto is the major unit of division in epics or other long narrative poems. It was first employed in English by Edmund Spenser in *The Faerie Queene*.

Caricature - A caricature is an exaggerated, usually comical, portrayal of a person or subject.

Carol - A hymn or poem often sung by a group, with an individual taking the changing stanzas and the group taking the burden or refrain.

Catharsis - Catharsis is the purification or purgation of the emotions (especially pity and fear) primarily through art. It allows audience to experience profound emotional release.

Catastrophe - Catastrophe is the final action that completes the unraveling of the plot in a play, especially in a tragedy.

Chronicle - Early records of events arranged chronologically.

Chorus - The term 'chorus' refers to a group of performers responsible for summarizing the events of a play.

Cliche - A cliché is an expression that was once innovative but has lost its novelty due to overuse.

Climax - Climax is the highest point of tension on drama in a narratives plot.

Closet Drama - Closet dramas are plays that have been written to be read, but not performed.

Conceit - Conceit is used to designate an ingenious and fanciful notion or conception, usually expressed through analogy and pointing to a striking parallel between two seemingly dissimilar things.

Curtain Raiser - It is a short play usually of one scene that is presented before the main full length drama.

Dirge - A brief hymn on song of lamentation and grief. It is typically composed to be performed at

a funeral.

Decadence - It is a period of decline or deterioration of art or literature that follows an era of great achievement.

Dissociation of Sensibility - It refers to the way in which intellectual thought was separated from the experience of feeling in seventeenth century poetry. The term was first used by T.S. Eliot in the essay 'The Metaphysical Poets' in 1921.

Doggerel - A doggerel is a type of crude, awkwardly composed verse that is generally viewed as having little literary value.

Dramatic Irony-The words or acts of a character in a play carrying a meaning unperceived by himself or other characters but understood by the audience.

Denouement-It is a final resolution or clarification in a literary work.

Eclogue-It is a short pastoral poem in which Shepherds converse with others.

Elegy-Elegy is a poem or song expressing sorrow or lament or one pervaded merely by a tone of pensive sadness. Ex: Lycidas

Epic - Epic is a long narrative poem which tells about heroes or heroic deeds, usually of high significance and embodying its early history or traditions. Ex.: Milton's 'Paradise Lost'

Epistle - A letter in verse, usually addressed to a person close to the writer.

Epistolary novel - It refers to the works of fiction that are written in the forms of letter or other

documents.

Epithalamion-It is a special poem written in honor of a marriage.

Euphemism-It is the substitution of a less offensive or agreeable expression for an expression that may offered or suggest something unpleasant.

Existentialism-Existentialism is a movement of 20th century literature that focuses on the individual and his on her relationship with the universe or god.

Expressionism-It is a style of art, literature and music which uses symbols and exaggeration to represent emotions, rather than representing physical reality.

Farce-A farce is a comedy in which everything is absolutely absurd. It usually involves some kind of deception or miscommunication.

Free Verse-Poetry that doesn't use any strict meter or rhyme scheme.

Genre-Type or class of a literary work, form or technique.

Gothic novel-European romantic pseudomedieval fiction having a prevailing of mystery and terror.

Harangue - It is a lengthy and intense speech, lecture or spoken attack.

Heroic couplet - It is a pair of rhyming lines that is present in a heroic poem or that relays themes of heroism within a larger poem.

Hymn - Song of praise, usually addressed to a deity.

Heroic line - iambic pentameter line, used for heroic or epic poetry in English.

Idyll - Idyll is a short poem of a pastoral or rural character in which something of the element of landscape is depicted or suggested.

Imagery - It refers to visual pictures of other sensory experiences evoked by the writer.

Impressionism - Impressionism in literature refers to stories dependent on a character's subjective point of view.

Interlude - A short play of a kind believed to have been performed by small companies of professional actors in the intervals of banquets and other entertainments.

Irony - Form of wit in which the opposite to what one really means is said.

Jargon - It is a type of specialised language used within a particular field.

Lampoon - Virulent satire in prose or verse that is a gratuitous and sometimes unjust and malicious attack on an individual.

Lollards - They are followers of Wycliffe in the 14th and 15th century.

Lake Poets - Group of Romantic poets from the English lake district who wrote about nature and sublime. The authors were Wordsworth, S.T. Coleridge and Robert Southey.

Masque - Form of amateur and professional court entertainment current in 16th and 17th

masques - Both amateur and professional court entertainers performed in 16th and 17th centuries, comprising songs, dances, elaborate costumes and much stage machinery. Ben Jonson was a famous masque writer.

Miracle Play - A play in which sacred subjects are represented from the lives of saints. It is very popular in middle ages.

Mystery Play - A medieval religious drama which represented scenes from the lives of Christ or stories from the old Testament associated with the coming of Messiah.

Monody - Poem, especially of mourning, spoken by one person only. e.g. Milton's 'Lycidas'.

Myth - Stories that are handed down from older times, containing the early beliefs of a race, especially explanations of natural events, such as the seasons.

Malapropism - A malapropism is an incorrect and used accidentally in place of another word with a similar sound. It can be humorous because they give rise to nonsensical statements.

Meiosis - Meiosis can be defined as a witty understatement that belittles or dismisses something or somebody, particularly by making use of terms that gives impression that something is less important than it should be.

Memoir - A memoir is a record of events written by a person having intimate knowledge of them and based on personal observation,

Metafiction - Metafiction is a style of prose narrative in which attention is directed to the process of fictive composition.

Metaphysical conceit - A metaphysical conceit is an extended metaphor that makes an

Metaphysical conceit - A metaphysical conceit is an extended metaphor that makes an outstretched comparison between a person's spiritual faculties and a physical object in the world. Metaphysical poets such as John Donne and Andrew Marvell, used metaphysical conceits to explore the relationships between lovers.

Metaphysical Poets - It is a term coined by the poet and critic 'Samuel Johnson' to describe a loose group of English lyric poets of the 17th century, whose work was characterised by the inventive use of conceits and by speculation about topics such as love as religion. John Donne was a leading poet was Metaphysical Poetry.

Modernism - Modernism was a literary movement that focuses on contemporary elements. It is a period in literary history which started around the early 1900s and continued until the early 1940s. The significant writers are- G.B. Shaw, Samuel Beckett, Harold Pinter, Virginia Woolf, D. H. Lawrence, W.B. Yeats, T.S. Eliot and W.H. Auden.

Naturalism - Naturalism was a literary movement taking place from 1865 to 1900 that used detailed realism to suggest that social conditions, heredity and environment had unescapable force in shaping human character.

Naturalist writers were influenced by the evolution theory of Charles Darwin. Major naturalist authors include Stephen Crane, Jack London, Frank Norris and Edith Wharton.

Naturalism was first proposed and formulated by Emile zola.

Negative capability - It characterizes a writer's immense capacity for sympathetic identification with some object dearer to him than himself.

The term was coined by John Keats.

Nemesis - Nemesis refers to a situation of poetic justice, where the good characters are rewarded for their virtues and the evil characters are punished for their vices.

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Neologism - The use of a word or term that has recently been created.

Non-Fiction - It is a genre in literature in which real events are depicted using story-telling techniques. Autobiographers, biographies, essays, reports, letters, memoir and newspaper articles are all types of non-fiction.

Novella - A piece of fiction shorter than a book-length novel but longer than a short story. The famous example are Joseph Conrad's, 'Heart of Darkness'.

Objective Correlative - It is a term used by T.S. Eliot to describe 'a set of objects', a situation, a chain of events which shall be the formula of that particular emotion' that the poet feels and hopes to evoke in the reader.

The term was coined by Washington Allston.

Zeugma - A Zeugma is a literary term for using one word to modify two other words, in two different ways.

Zoomorphism - It is the device of giving animal like qualities to anything that is not that animal such as humans, gods and inanimate objects.

Biography - A biography is simply the story of a real person's life. It could be about a person who is still alive, someone who lived centuries ago, someone who is globally famous, an unsung hero forgotten by history, or even a unique group of people. The facts of their life, from birth to death, are included with life-changing moments often taking center stage.

John Dryden has explained a biography in these words 'the history of particular person's life' in 17th century. Initially, it was a short record of person's life

but gradually, it changed and covers the vast field a person's life.

- The 'Lives' by Izaak Walton is a biography on the Lives of John Donne and George Herbert can be taken as the first authentic biography in English that covers the time from 1640 to 1678.
- In the 18th century, Dr. Samuel Johnson wrote The lives of the English Poets' within three years (1779. 1781).
- The Life of Samuel Johnson' (1791) is a remarkable work by James Boswell on the life of Jonson.

Example of Biographical Works-

Steve Jobs (Walter Isaacson)
The Black Rose (Tananarive Due),
John Adams (David McCullough)
Team of Rivals: The Political Genius of Abraham Lincoln
Shirley Jackson A Rather Haunted Life (Ruth Franklin)

Autobiography- An autobiography is a self-written life story.

{Auto - self, Bio - Life, Graphy - printed or written}

Autobiography - Self Life Printed or written

It is different from a biography, which is the life story of a person written by someone else. The word 'autobiography' was first used by William Taylor in 1797 in the English periodical, the Monthly Review.

John Henry Newman's work 'Apologia Pro Vita Sua' which was first published in 1864 is a Christian confessional work.

Joseph Vita by Flavius Josephus introduced autobiography as self-praise in the Jewish community. The earliest English autobiography is known as 'Book of Marge Kempe, Some well known autobiographies are-'Grace Abounding to the Chief of Sinners (1666) by John Bunyan,

Liber Amoris (1823) by William Hazlitt, 'My Experiments with Truth' by M.K. Gandhi, 'Dichtung and Wahrheit' by Goethe, etc. Spiritual autobiography shows the crucial experience in Christian autobiography, mental crisis of the author, a recovery and conversion to find Christian identity and religious vocation.

Example of Autobiography-

- 'The Box: Tales from the Darkroom' by Gunter Grass.
- 'The Story of My life' by Helen Keller
- 'Self Portraits' fictions by Frederic Tuten
- 'My Prizes' by Thomas Bernhard
- 'The Autobiography of Benjamin Franklin' by Benjamin Franklin.

Memoir- A memoir is a narrative, written from the perspective of the author, about an important part of their life. It's often conflated with autobiography, but there are a few important differences.

Memoir can be defined as 'reminiscence' of one's life. It is a story with a proper narrative shape, focus and subject matter involving reflections on some events or places or persons.

Example of Memoir-

- Ernest Hemingway wrote 'A Moveable Feast' (1964) as a collection of stories about his time spent in Paris in 1920's.
- The 'Speak Memory' by Vladimir Nabokov is another sparkling example of a memoir which gives an account of his childhood before moving to America in 1940.
- George Orwell wrote 'Homage to Catalonia' presenting his days during the Spanish Civil War.
- Henry David Thoreau could pen a memoir namely 'Walden' which presents his experiences over the course of two years in a cabin he built near Walden Pond.
- 'Maus' By Art Spiegelman

Travel Writing- A kind of writing which gives an account of a travel with a vivid narration and full scope to what the author witnessed on his way to destination is known as a Travel writing.

It can be seen in the work of Pausanias, a Greek geographer during second century named, description of Greece, which was written in ten books. Many travel journals were written in later world. The Journey through Wales' (1191) and description of Wales (1194) were written by Gerald of Wales during 12th century. The Petit Jehan de Saintre' by Antoine de la Sale who climbed to the crater of a volcano in the Lipari Islands in 1407, is an excellent example of travel writing. 'Voyages' which was the work of Richard Hakluyt, can be marked writing or travel literature. V.S. Naipaul could write 'India: A Wounded Civilization' (1976) as a trip to observations on a nation and people.

University Wits - The University Wits is a phrase used to name a group of late 16th century English playwrights and Pamphleteers who were educated at the universities and who became popular secular writers.

Prominent members of this group were Christopher Marlowe, Robert Greene, and Thomas Nashe from Cambridge, and John Lyly, Thomas Lodge and George Peele from Oxford.

Thomas Kyd is also sometimes included in the group, though he is not believed to have studied at university.

The term 'University Wits' was not used in their lifetime, it was coined by George Saintsbury, a 19th century, journalist and author.